

## Negative Double

Partner opens 1 of a suit and the next opponent overcalls a suit:

Double by you is not for penalty - it says you **would** have responded if no overcall.

You need 6+ points for 1-level double, more for higher level double

Negative Double promises at least four cards in any unbid Major

If both Majors have been bid, double promises both minors

1♣/♦ - 1♥ - dbl - promises 4-card Spade suit

1♣/♦ - 1♥ - 1♠ - promises 5+ card Spade suit

## Support Cue-bid

When partner opens and next player overcalls, a Cue-bid by you shows Limit-raise or better support for partner's suit. Any raise of partner's suit is preemptive and shows LESS than a Limit-raise.

When an opponent opens, partner overcalls, and the next opponent passes, a Cue-bid by you shows Limit-raise or better support for partner's suit. Any raise of partner's suit is preemptive and shows LESS than a Limit-raise.

Board: 1

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 4♠

Declarer: North

Lead: ♠3

Board: 2

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 3NT

Declarer: East

Lead: ♠J

Board: 3

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 4♠

Declarer: South

Lead: ♦K

Board: 4

Dealer: **West**

Contract: 3NT

Declarer: West

Lead: ♣2

Board: 5

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 4♥

Declarer: North

Lead: ♦3

**Board 1**

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 10 5  
 ♥ J 10 9 2  
 ♦ A K Q 5  
 ♣ J 10 3

♠ A K J 7

♥ 8 7

♦ 9 7 6

♣ K Q 5 4



♠ 8 4 3

♥ Q 6 4

♦ J 10 3 2

♣ 9 8 7

♠ Q 9 6 2

♥ A K 5 3

♦ 8 4

♣ A 6 2

SOUTH has both Majors and planned on bidding 1♥ first, (up-the-line). But EAST's overcall gave SOUTH the opportunity to bid both Majors at the same time! Since the Negative Double promises both Majors it was like SOUTH could bid 1♥♠.

NORTH has ♠s so she bids 1♠, showing a minimum opener.

SOUTH has 13 points and the ♠ fit so he bids game.

| West        | North | East | South |
|-------------|-------|------|-------|
|             | 1♣    | 1♦   | Dbl   |
| Pass        | 1♠    | Pass | 4♠    |
| All Pass    |       |      |       |
| 4♠ by North |       |      |       |
| Lead: ♠3    |       |      |       |

**Board 2**

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ A K 6 2  
♥ A 10 9 3  
♦ 9 7  
♣ Q 8 2

♠ 5 4 3

♥ Q 5 4

♦ Q 8 5 2

♣ 7 6 3

|   |   |   |
|---|---|---|
|   | N |   |
| W |   | E |
|   | S |   |

♠ Q 9 7

♥ J 8 7

♦ A K 6

♣ K J 10 4

♠ J 10 8

♥ K 6 2

♦ J 10 4 3

♣ A 9 5

WEST has 13 points and four cards in both ♥s and ♠s. Rather than bid one of them she makes a Negative Double, promising four cards in EACH of them. It's like she was able to bid 1 ♥♠.

EAST doesn't have four cards in either Major, but with a ♦ stopper he bids 1NT.

WEST happily bids 3NT.

| West        | North | East | South |
|-------------|-------|------|-------|
|             |       | 1♣   | 1♦    |
| Dbl         | Pass  | 1NT  | Pass  |
| 3NT         |       |      |       |
| All Pass    |       |      |       |
| 3NT by East |       |      |       |
| Lead: ♠J    |       |      |       |

**Board 3**

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 5 3  
♥ Q 10 6 4  
♦ A K 10 5  
♣ 10 9 8

♠ A K J 7

♥ 8 7

♦ 9 7 6

♣ K Q 5 4



♠ 10 8 4

♥ J 9 3 2

♦ Q J 3 2

♣ J 7

♠ Q 9 6 2

♥ A K 5

♦ 8 4

♣ A 6 3 2

SOUTH cannot respond with a Negative Double on this hand because he has only three ♥s.

Instead he just bids his 4-card Major, 1 ♠.

NORTH shows 4-card support with a minimum opener by bidding 2 ♠ and SOUTH has enough strength to bid game.

| West         | North | East | South |
|--------------|-------|------|-------|
|              | 1 ♣   | 1 ♦  | 1 ♠   |
| Pass         | 2 ♠   | Pass | 4 ♠   |
| All Pass     |       |      |       |
| 4 ♠ by South |       |      |       |
| Lead: ♦ K    |       |      |       |

**Board 4**

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ A 10 5 3 2

♥ A J 10

♦ 9 8 7

♣ A 8

♠ Q 7 4

♥ K 5 4

♦ Q 5 4

♣ J 6 3 2

|   |   |   |
|---|---|---|
|   | N |   |
| W |   | E |
|   | S |   |

♠ K 9

♥ 8 6 2

♦ A K 6 3

♣ K Q 7 5

♠ J 8 6

♥ Q 9 7 3

♦ J 10 2

♣ 10 9 4

EAST has 15 points, and when North overcalls 2♥ in front of her she has a perfect Negative Double - showing both of the Minor suits.

WEST doesn't like the Minor suits, but he has stoppers in ♥s, so he bids 2NT.

EAST is more than happy to raise to 3NT.

*West*

1♠

2NT

All Pass

3NT by West

Lead: ♣2

*North*

2♥

Pass

*East*

Dbl

3NT

*South*

Pass

**Board 5**

North Deals  
None Vul

♠ K 5 4 2  
♥ 8 5  
♦ J 10 7 5  
♣ J 9 8

♠ 9  
♥ K Q J 7  
♦ A K 6  
♣ A Q 10 5 4

|   |   |   |
|---|---|---|
|   | N |   |
| W |   | E |
|   | S |   |

♠ A Q J 7 3  
♥ 10 3  
♦ Q 9 3 2  
♣ 7 3

♠ 10 8 6  
♥ A 9 6 4 2  
♦ 8 4  
♣ K 6 2

SOUTH would have responded 1♥ if EAST had not overcalled. But with only 8 points he cannot bid at the 2-level. The Negative Double solves his problem, giving this information to partner.

NORTH has good ♥s and enough points to bid game. Notice that if EAST had remained silent, SOUTH would have responded 1♥, and NORTH would have jumped to game.

| West        | North | East | South |
|-------------|-------|------|-------|
|             | 1♣    | 1♠   |       |
| Pass        | 4♥    |      | Dbl   |
| All Pass    |       |      |       |
| 4♥ by North |       |      |       |
| Lead: ♦ 3   |       |      |       |